

COLLABORATIVE DISCUSSION 1:
SUMMARY POST -
CROSS-INDUSTRY SYNTHESIS AND
THE IMPLEMENTATION GAP

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SUMMARY POST

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Initially I explored Industry 4.0 and 5.0 framing connected to benefits, resilience, risks and trade-offs: BMW's AI-enabled systems show how data can improve reliability, speed and production decisions (BMW Group, 2023, 2025), whilst the Jaguar Land Rover cyber incident showed the opposite: once the chain relies on intertwined automated information systems, a failure can become an operational and reputational crisis (Reuters, 2025).

Peer discussions enriched the learning, with pharmaceutical and HSE examples showcasing that resilience failures affect supply chains, research, clinical services and patient safety. Outages can affect and cascade across a digital ecosystem (Janardhan, 2021), and examples in the education sector show that digital transformation can affect the users it is meant to protect in the first place, the more vulnerable ones; harms can be more than financial; social equality and trust can break down too.

This exposes an implementation gap; although Industry 5.0 is framed around human-centricity, sustainability and resilience (European Commission, 2021; Metcalf, 2024), there is public evidence suggesting these may be aspirational rather than implemented. Accenture (2025) reports that only 28% of organisations embed security into transformation initiatives, while the World Economic Forum (2025a) finds that fewer than half of CEOs believe their organisations invest enough in cybersecurity.

The overall discussion influenced me to move from seeing it as an efficiency opportunity to seeing it as a socio-technical dependency problem with broader impact and a need to address gaps.

I would like to see Industry 5.0 not only describe alignment with resilience and human-centricity but also incorporate measurement into how this should be funded, tested and governed. This could include recovery drills, manual fallback plans, supplier-risk controls, reskilling budgets and labour impact assessments, especially

given the skills gap and upskilling pressures identified by the World Economic Forum (OECD, 2023; World Economic Forum, 2025b). Otherwise, the evolution may continue profiting from efficiency while risking leaving aside its core human and resiliency values.

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